

Contoso Infrastructure — WestLink Road Upgrade Close-Out Report

Project Summary

Field	Details
Project Name	WestLink Road Upgrade — Stages 2 & 3
Client	Department of Transport & Main Roads (QLD)
Contract Type	Design & Construct
Contract Value	\$215M (original), \$221M (final)
Duration	28 months (Jun 2023 – Sep 2025)
Location	Western Brisbane corridor, QLD
Scope	8km road widening (4 to 6 lanes), 2 new interchanges, 3km noise walls

Financial Performance

Budget vs Actual

Cost Category	Budget (\$M)	Actual (\$M)	Variance
Earthworks	28.5	27.2	-4.6%
Pavement	32.0	31.5	-1.6%
Structures (bridges/walls)	38.4	39.8	+3.6%
Drainage & services	22.6	24.1	+6.6%
Traffic management	18.2	19.5	+7.1%
Noise walls	12.8	12.4	-3.1%
ITS & electrical	8.5	9.2	+8.2%
Landscaping	6.0	5.8	-3.3%
Preliminaries	32.0	33.5	+4.7%
Subcontractors	16.0	18.0	+12.5%
TOTAL	215.0	221.0	+2.8%

Key Unit Rates Achieved

Item	Tendered Rate	Actual Rate	Variance
Bulk excavation (soil)	\$17.50/m ³	\$16.80/m ³	-4.0%
Road base (200mm)	\$30.00/m ²	\$29.50/m ²	-1.7%
Asphalt (50mm wearing)	\$36.00/m ²	\$37.20/m ²	+3.3%
Concrete 32MPa	\$280.00/m ³	\$288.00/m ³	+2.9%
Noise wall panels (precast)	\$450/m ²	\$435/m ²	-3.3%
Structural steel (bridges)	\$5,600/t	\$5,850/t	+4.5%

Subcontractor Performance

Subcontractor Summary

Subcontractor	Trade	Value (\$M)	Performance Rating
QLD Earth Movers Pty Ltd	Earthworks	18.2	★★★★★ (Excellent)
BridgeCo Australia	Bridge construction	28.5	★★★★ (Good)
Pacific Drainage Solutions	Drainage	14.8	★★★ (Average)
SoundBlock Pty Ltd	Noise walls	12.4	★★★★★ (Excellent)
Apex Electrical	ITS & lighting	9.2	★★ (Below expectations)

Subcontractor Issues

- QLD Earth Movers** — Exceptional performance. Completed earthworks 3 weeks ahead of program. Negotiated volume discount of 4% for quantities above 500,000m³. Recommend for all future QLD road projects.
- Pacific Drainage Solutions** — Adequate quality but consistent program delays (2-3 weeks behind on each stage). Resource constraints during peak period. Consider larger subcontractor for future projects with tight drainage programs.
- Apex Electrical** — Significant issues:
- 6 weeks behind program on ITS installation
 - 3 defect notices issued for non-compliant cable routing
 - Required additional supervision from Contoso project team
 - Additional cost of \$0.8M for remediation and supervision
 - **Recommendation: Do not re-engage. Source alternative ITS subcontractor.**

Rate Comparison: QLD vs Other Regions

Based on this project's actual rates compared to Contoso's rate library:

Item	QLD (This Project)	NSW (M7 Project)	Difference
Earthworks (soil)	\$16.80/m ³	\$18.20/m ³	QLD 8% cheaper
Concrete 32MPa	\$288/m ³	\$285/m ³	Similar
Road base	\$29.50/m ²	—	—
Asphalt	\$37.20/m ²	—	—
Structural steel	\$5,850/t	\$6,100/t	QLD 4% cheaper
Labor (general)	\$66/hr	\$65/hr	Similar

Key insight: QLD earthworks consistently 5-10% cheaper than NSW due to lower disposal costs and better material availability. Steel prices converging across states due to national supply chain.

Lessons Learned

What Went Well

1. **Earthworks** — partnering with QLD Earth Movers delivered excellent value; volume discount model works well
2. **Noise walls** — precast panels from SoundBlock reduced installation time by 40% vs in-situ casting
3. **Program** — overall 2.8% cost variance on a \$215M D&C project is within acceptable tolerance
4. **Community engagement** — proactive noise management during night works reduced complaints by 70%

What Could Improve

1. **ITS subcontractor** — vetting process missed capability gaps; add mandatory reference checks for electrical/ITS trades
2. **Drainage program** — underestimated coordination between drainage and road widening; allocate dedicated drainage coordinator on future widening projects
3. **Traffic management** — night work restrictions in residential areas added \$1.3M; factor residential proximity uplift into estimates
4. **Asphalt pricing** — bitumen price increase mid-project; consider escalation provisions for projects > 18 months

Recommendations for Future Projects

- Volume-based earthworks subcontracts with discount tiers
- Precast noise walls as default (not in-situ) for road widening projects
- Mandatory 3-reference check for all subcontractors above \$5M
- Residential proximity factor: add 7-10% to traffic management for adjacent residential areas
- Escalation provisions mandatory for bitumen/fuel-linked items on projects > 18 months

This document is for workshop demonstration purposes only. All data is fictional.